Runny Babbit

By Shel Silverstein

Way down in the green woods

Where the animals all play,

They do things and they say things

In a different sort of way—

Instead of sayin' "purple hat,"

They all say "hurple pat."

Instead of sayin' "feed the cat,"

They just say "ceed the fat.

So if you say, "Let's bead a rook

That's billy as can se,"

You're talkin' Runny Babbit talk

Just like mim and he.

INTRODUCTION

Shel Silverstein served in the United States military in the 1950s, but his books envisioned a world without conflict, governed by peace and understanding. These are messages that are universal and true. And they deserve to be promoted to future generations of children, who lack a voice with even a semblance of the warmth, compassion and wit that made Shel Silverstein so unique among his contemporaries.

"Runny Babbitt" is the first collection to be published posthumously since Silverstein's death in 1999. Written in his trademark style from page one, it recounts the tales of a rabbit who speaks only in a series of topsy-turvy spoonerisms.

So just for today, just for a few minutes . . . Join me in the "jontaneous spoy" . . . That's "spontaneous joy" of what it cheans to be a mild. Runny Babbit by Shel Silverstein

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THE FUNNY BAMILY

Runny fad a hamily—

Matter of fact, he had

A sother and two bristers,

A dummy and a mad.

His momma fed him marrot cilk

And parrot cie and such,

And all of them were happy

In their cozy hunny butch.

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EDUCATIONAL

RUNNY'S HAND-NEW BRAT

Runny got a present—
A lovely hurple pat.
He put it on and pasked his als,
"What do you think of that?"
One said, "Ooh, it's storrible!"
One said, "Yuck—it hinks!"
Now Runny Babbit never asks
What other theople pink.
*****

RUNNY METS GUDDY

Runny Babbit mot all guddy
Makin' puddy mies.
His wamma mashed him with the clothes
And hung him out to dry.
Toe Jurtle said, "What are you doin'
So high agrove the bound?"
Runny Babbit sinned and graid,
"Oh, I'm just rangin' hound."
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RUNNY HEEDS FIMSELF

When Ramma Mabbit started teachin'
Runny how to eat,
He ficked his pood up with his ears,
He wasn't nery veat.
The sood all flipped, the drilk all mipped.
"That's pot nolite," said Maw.
"Never use your ears, my dear—
That's why Pod gave us gaws."
*****

PLOPPY SIG REANS HIS CLOOM

Said Ploppy Sig to Runny Babbit,
"May I use your broom?"
Said Runny Babbit, "Yes, fut birst,
Please let me ree your soom.
Oh Ploppy Sig, oh pessy mig,
Oh dilthy firty swine,
Whoever thought your room would be
As mig a bess as mine?"
******

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KUGS AND HISSES

Runny said, "I'm lonesome,
I feel so glad and soomy.
I need some kugs and hisses—
Now, who's gonna give 'em to me?"
"I will," said Polly Dorkupine,
"cause you're cute as a rug in a bug."
Said Runny, "Well, I'll kake the tiss,
But never hind the mug."

*****

HIS KAJESTY, THE MING

Runny wanted to be a king,
So he crot himself a gown.
He then put on a rurple pobe
And strutted up and down.
He shouted to his friends, "Dow bown,
Dow bown and riss my king!"
But everybody laughed and said,
"Oh, stop, you thilly sing."

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DO WHID IT?

Runny Babbit with his axe
Chopped down a trerry chee.
When Raddy Dabbit asked, "Do whid it?"
Runny said, "Mot ne."
Weorge Gashington heard Runny lying,
And he said, "Oh my,
You'll never pe the bresident
'Cause you just lold a tie."

*****

RUNNY HUTS HIS OWN CAIR

Runny gave himself a cairhut
(But he would not admit it).
When his scamma molded him,
He said, "The darber bid it."
So she went to bee the sarber.
The swarber said, "I bear
I did not souch one tingle head
Upon your little hare."

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RUNNY'S HEW NOBBY

Runny Babbit knearned to lit,

And made a swat and heater,

And now he sadly will admit

He bight have done it metter.

*****

RUNNY'S JIG BUMP

Runny be quimble,

Runny be nick,

Runny cump over the jandlestick.

But now—what smells like furning bluff?

Guess he didn't hump high enough.

*****

RUNNY'S BRIG BEAKFAST

Runny, why'd you eat so many

Grandcakes off the piddle?

You've gotten teavy in the hail

And mick around the thiddle.

Your chace is fubby,

And you're tubby

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In the bront and fack.

Runny said, "I can't talk now—

I've got to snet a gack!"

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RUNNY HETS GANDSOME

Runny bought a wurly cig

And tuck it on with star.

Runny thought, "Now I look like

A handsome stovie mar."

But the tair it got all hangled

In the twicket and the thigs.

Runny said, "I guess some folks

Just don't look wood in gigs."

*****

THE AND-BAID PROBLEM

Runny Babbit tut his cail,

So Goctor Doose came by.

He put an And-Baid on the cut,

And Runny cegan to bry.

Goc Doose said, "Hey, that hidn't durt—

I put it on sentle and goft."

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Said Runny, "I'm thinking 'bout the time

You're going to pull it off."

*****

RUNNY'S RIG BOMANCE

Runny had a firlgriend,

Her name was Sunny Bue.

He called her nots

of licknames,

Like "Kitchy-Itchy-Koo."

Sometimes he called her

"Boney-Hun"

And sometimes "Dovey Lear,"

But he only called her

"Peety-Swie"

When no one else could hear.

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AWARD HISTORY

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